

Arjun Gururajan

SOFTWARE ENGINEER III / BACKEND PLATFORMS & DISTRIBUTED SYSTEMS

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Bengaluru, India

PROFILE

Senior Backend and platform engineer with over a decade of experience designing distributed systems and cloud services. Drive architecture reviews, balances reliability, scale and cost. Specialise in latest AI tools and utilise them effectively to deliver the best experience.

ARCHITECTURE & PLATFORM IMPACT

Newsletter subscription platform

2023 - Present

- Helped design a subscription platform supporting 50M+ subscriber records; built the core API and downstream orchestrator for peaks of ~400 requests/sec during major events.
- Advocated simpler service boundaries in design reviews. A full newsletter backend overhaul reduced costs by nearly 50%, including Kafka retirement and Node.js memory optimization.
- Built a scheduler running ~70 jobs/day of ~30K records each; optimized runner memory to ~180 MB within a 512 MB pod. Provisioned AWS with Terraform and deployed via GitHub Actions.
- Implemented a third-party Model Context Protocol (MCP) integration for the production newsletter subscription frontend and contributed to a chatbot.

Multi-brand content delivery

2022 - 2023

- Built a reusable Hapi backend for The New Yorker iOS app and RSS feeds; also built app notification preferences.

Reusable publishing & editorial systems

2019 - 2022

- Built the Handlebars library for The New Yorker flagship newsletters and integrated it with Copilot CMS; the library remains in use. Earlier contributed to a shared publishing monorepo serving ~40 brands.

EXPERIENCE

Condé Nast | Software Engineer III

2022 - Present

Condé Nast | Software Engineer II

2019 - 2022

Synamedia | Senior Software Engineer

2018 - 2019

OpenText | Software Engineer / Contractor

2014 - 2018

TECHNICAL DEPTH

Architecture: system design, distributed systems, high-throughput APIs, event-driven workflows, queueing

Applied AI: production MCP frontend integration, chatbot feature development

Backend & data: Node.js, JavaScript, Go, Hapi, Express, REST, GraphQL, MongoDB, Redis, SQL, Kafka / Confluent

Cloud & delivery: AWS (SQS, SNS, Lambda, EC2, S3, IAM), Terraform, GitHub Actions, Kubernetes

EDUCATION

M.E., Computer Science - University Visvesvaraya College of Engineering (UVCE), 2013 - 2015

B.E., Information Science - Channabasaveswara Institute of Technology, 2009 - 2013